

Chapter

Independence and Partition of India

1. Look at the picture given and answer the following questions:



- (i) Name the Viceroy who announced the plan for smooth transfer of power. Mention any two clauses of his plan with reference to the Princely States.
- (ii) Mention any three reasons for the acceptance of his plan by the Congress.
- (iii) Mention any four provisions of the Indian Independence Act of 1947.

MAIN 2024

2. According to Mount batten Plan which is incorrect regarding the status of Princely States?

- (a) They will become independent
- (b) All treaties would end.
- (c) Plebiscite will be held
- (d) Freedom to associate with any dominion

MAIN 2023

3. Give two reasons for the acceptance of the Mount batten Plan by the Congress.

MAIN 2023

4. The Cabinet Mission was commissioned by the British Government in February 1946 to find a solution for constitutional reforms in India. In the light of this, answer the following questions:

(i) Who were the members of the Cabinet Mission?

(ii) Why was the Cabinet Mission appointed?

(iii) Why didn't the Mission concede to the League's demand for Pakistan?

MAIN 2023

5. In the historic photograph, Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, is being sworn in as Prime Minister of free India. In this context, answer the following :



(i) Mention the Provisions of the Indian Independence Act of 1947 regarding the Constituent Assembly.

(ii) Discuss the basic reasons why the Cabinet Mission Plan rejected the demand for Pakistan.

(iii) Mention the areas where plebiscites were to be held. What was the position of His Majesty's government in the new set-up in India?

MAIN 2023

6. Who replaced Lord Wavell ?

COMP 2023

7. Name any two provisions of the Mountbatten Plan.

COMP 2023

8. What was the most important but tragic provision of the Mount batten Plan?

SQP 2022

9. Indian Independence Act was unique in history, because never before had such a large population of the world achieved Independence through legislation. In this context answer the following questions :

(i) State three main provisions of the Indian Independence Act.

(ii) Who was appointed the first Governor - General for each of the two Dominions?

(iii) Mention the areas where plebiscites were to be held.

What was the position of His Majesty's government in the new set-up in India?

SQP 2022

10. Group A: United Provinces : : Group B : _____

(a) Baluchistan

(b) Punjab

(c) Delhi

(d) Bihar

COMP 2022

Solution

1.

Ans:

(i) The Viceroy who announced the plan for the smooth transfer of power was **Lord Mountbatten**.

Two clauses of his plan regarding the Princely States were:

1. The Princely States were given the option to **join India, join Pakistan, or remain independent**.
2. They were advised to consider **geographical position and the wishes of their people** while deciding.

(ii) Three reasons why the Congress accepted Mountbatten's plan were:

1. **To avoid civil war** and large-scale violence.
2. Desire for **quick independence**, without further delay.
3. Congress leaders realised that **keeping India united was no longer possible**, so partition seemed inevitable.

(iii) Four provisions of the Indian Independence Act of 1947 were:

1. India and Pakistan were created as **two independent dominions**.
2. **British rule in India ended**, and powers were transferred to Indian governments.
3. **Bengal and Punjab were divided** on religious grounds.
4. The Princely States were free to **join India, join Pakistan, or stay independent**.

2.

Ans: (c) Plebiscite will be held.

Explanation:

Under the Mount batten Plan, the Princely States were **free to join either India or Pakistan or remain independent**, and **all treaties with the British would end**. They were also given **freedom to associate with any dominion**.

However, **holding a plebiscite was not proposed as part of the plan**, making option (c) incorrect.

3.

Ans:

(i) The Congress accepted the Mountbatten Plan to prevent a potential civil war and large-scale communal violence between Hindus and Muslims.

(ii) It also provided a clear timeline for British withdrawal, ensuring a quick transfer of power, which the Congress wanted to end colonial rule as soon as possible.

4.

Ans:

(i) Members of the Cabinet Mission:

The Cabinet Mission consisted of **Lord Pethick-Lawrence, Sir Stafford Cripps, and A.V. Alexander**.

(ii) Reason for appointment:

The Mission was sent to **find a solution for constitutional reforms in India after World War II**, as rising nationalist pressure and the impact of the INA trials demanded a quick transfer of power.

(iii) Why the demand for Pakistan was rejected:

The Cabinet Mission **did not accept the Muslim League's demand for Pakistan** because:

- A large **non-Muslim population lived in the proposed Pakistan areas**, making separation impractical.
- The **division of Bengal, Assam, and Punjab** had no proper justification.
- **Partition would disrupt common defence, transport, and communications**, which were created for a united India.
- **Princely States would face difficulty** choosing between India and Pakistan.
- The **two parts of Pakistan would be 700 miles apart**, making governance difficult.

5.

Ans:

(i) Provisions of the Indian Independence Act of 1947 regarding the Constituent Assembly:

(a) **Two independent Dominions:** India and Pakistan were to become separate independent dominions from August 15, 1947.

(b) **Governor-General for each Dominion:** Each Dominion would have its own Governor-General acting as the representative of His Majesty.

(c) **Sovereign legislatures:** Both Dominions would have full authority to frame their own laws until new constitutions were made.

(d) **End of Paramountcy:** British paramountcy over Princely States would lapse from August 15, giving the States freedom to accede to either Dominion.

(ii) Basic reasons for rejecting the demand for Pakistan:

(a) A large population of non-Muslims would remain in Pakistan, failing to solve the minority issue.

(b) Inclusion of non-Muslim regions in Pakistan had no justification.

(c) Partition would disrupt united administrative, military, and communication systems.

(d) Princely States would struggle in choosing which Dominion to join.

(e) The proposed area of Pakistan would be divided by 700 miles, making governance difficult.

(iii) Areas where plebiscites were to be held and position of His Majesty's Government:

- **Plebiscites were to be held in:**

- (a) North West Frontier Province

- (b) Sylhet district (East Bengal)

- **Position of His Majesty's Government:**

His Majesty's Government would cease responsibility for India after August 15, 1947. All previous treaties with Indian States or tribal areas would become invalid, and the new Dominion government would

negotiate future agreements.

6.

Ans: Lord Mountbatten replaced Lord Wavell as the Viceroy of India.

Explanation:

In 1947, Lord Wavell was recalled by the British Government and replaced by Lord Mountbatten, who was given the responsibility of overseeing the final transfer of power and partition of India.

7.

Ans:

(i) Partition of India – India was to be divided into two independent dominions, India and Pakistan, largely on the basis of religious majorities.

(ii) Princely States – The princely states were given the choice to accede to either India or Pakistan, or to remain independent.

8.

Ans: The most important yet tragic provision of the Mountbatten Plan was the decision to transfer power without delay and to partition British India into two separate dominions—India and Pakistan.

9.

Ans:

(i) Three main provisions of the Indian Independence Act

1. India was divided into two independent dominions—**India and Pakistan**.
2. Each dominion's **Constituent Assembly became fully sovereign** to frame its Constitution and make laws.
3. The Act provided for the **division of the Army, assets, and liabilities** between India and Pakistan.

(ii) First Governor-General of each Dominion

- **India:** Lord Mountbatten
- **Pakistan:** Muhammad Ali Jinnah

(iii) Areas where plebiscites were to be held

- **North-West Frontier Province (NWFP)**
- **Sylhet district of Assam**

Position of His Majesty's Government in the new set-up

His Majesty's Government had **no control** over India and Pakistan after independence. Both dominions became **fully sovereign**, though they could remain in the **British Commonwealth** with the British monarch only as a **symbolic head**.

10.

Ans: Punjab

Explanation:

United Provinces (Group A) and Punjab (Group B) were grouped together as per the Cabinet Mission Plan's grouping system.

Therefore, the correct option is **(b) Punjab**.